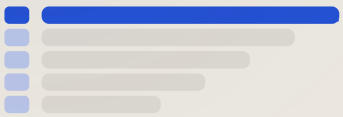
Models in the Agile Cadence

Make the models a habit: an ordered backlog, an honest quarter plan, and a weekly look at the numbers.

KEEP THE RANKING ALIVE

An ordered backlog SCRUM GUIDE



→ the Product Owner orders it: one thing first

The quarter's call sets what's in · a value model orders it · **dates are fixed points**

⚠ **High / Medium / Low hides the trade-off**

Sprint goal and Kanban

one objective · a slice of an outcome

→ deciding what can wait

Kanban: an ordered queue with a **work-in-progress limit**

⚠ **a ticket list is not a goal**

Refinement

evidence arrives →

input changes →

order changes

→ write the reason next to every change

⚠ **re-scoring when someone is louder**

PLAN THE QUARTER

SAFe WSJF

big-room planning · WSJF

→ alignment across many teams

⚠ **weight: roles, ceremonies, estimates**

Shape Up BASECAMP

appetite · betting table

→ small trusted teams that cut scope

⚠ **fixed external dates**

Now · Next · Later BASTOW

NOW	NEXT	LATER
committed	being shaped	problems

→ rows as outcomes; dates only where real

⚠ **a dated timeline promises false certainty**

THE MEASUREMENT CADENCE

One dashboard

Top	North Star
Middle	inputs
Bottom	guardrails, **limit drawn on the chart**

⚠ **definitions drift: check each quarter**

Weekly review AMAZON WBR

1	What moved? Is it real?
2	Any guardrail near its limit?
3	Any experiment needing a decision?
4	One action, one owner

⚠ **a review that never changes a decision**

When a guardrail trips

limit + **owner** +

agreed response

→ a same-day decision, not a debate

⚠ **agreeing the response after it trips**

THREE RULES

Change the order when the evidence changes.

Borrow framework parts; name the problem each fixes.

The quarterly review feeds the next plan.

WHEN THESE MISLEAD YOU

A ranking set once: reflects week one's beliefs

A silent change: looks like politics

A whole framework: ceremonies for problems you don't have

A ritual review: change the review

Rank, measure, test. Then do it again next quarter.

Sources: Schwaber & Sutherland, *The Scrum Guide* (2020); 18th State of Agile; Singer, *Shape Up* (2019); Bastow (ProdPad); Bryar & Carr, *Working Backwards* (2021).